CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

DOG TRAINER IN THE AI ERA

Apps can teach a dog owner theory. The leash work — timing, reading the dog, coaching the human — happens in person.

★ TL;DR — Around ~$75K on the site's scale for an established trainer, startable in 1–6 months with no license. The catch: you train owners more than dogs, and evenings and weekends are prime time. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

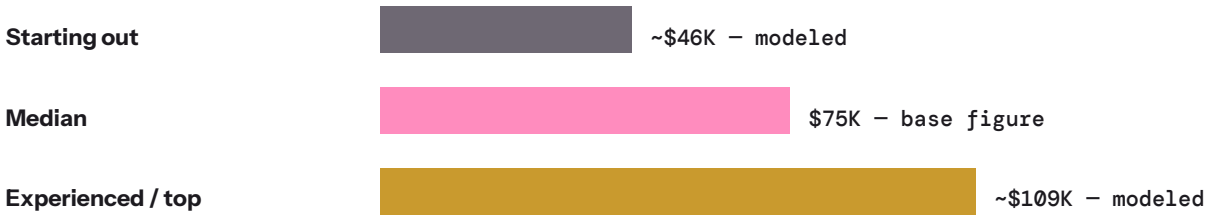
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$75K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK LOW

- Private lessons and board-and-train are the money formats; group classes fill the funnel.
- No license exists for this — reputation, results and insurance are your credentials.
- Video programs teach concepts; live coaching fixes real handling in real moments.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Dog Trainer is a ~$75K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A DOG TRAINER ACTUALLY DO?

✓ Assess dogs and owners; design training plans

- ✓ Run private lessons, classes and board-and-train programs
- ✓ Coach owners' timing, leash skills and consistency
- ✓ Film progress content; manage bookings and follow-ups

Think: a personal trainer where the client has four legs, the owner holds the leash — and the habits.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Training apps, video libraries and AI-generated plans cover generic education. Marketing and scheduling are fully automatable.	Reading a dog's body language second by second, adjusting in the moment, and changing the owner's behavior — live coaching is the product.

⚠ **Problem cases — bites, aggression — carry real liability; taking cases beyond your skill is how trainers get hurt and sued.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Dogs daily, outdoors often, visible transformations ✓ Premium private rates once results are known ✓ Partly remote: online lessons and programs extend reach	✗ Owners who won't practice undo your work weekly ✗ Evenings and weekends are when clients are free ✗ Bite risk is occupational, not theoretical

Good fit? Dog-literate, a patient teacher, and honest about your case limits.
Bad fit? You love dogs but dislike coaching people.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — APPRENTICE UNDER A PRO	DOOR B — CERTIFY AND LAUNCH SOLO
Shadow and assist an established trainer or training facility: handle many dogs, learn case variety and client coaching. Volunteer shelter work builds dog-reading hours fast.	Complete a respected trainer certification course, insure yourself, and launch with puppy and manners packages. Certification isn't a license — it's a trust signal while results build your name.

Smart move: Sell a defined transformation package — a multi-week leash-reactivity program, say — instead of hourly lessons; outcomes price better than time.

Where you land after: Booked private trainer → a board-and-train facility, or a small team of trainers.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
BUILD DOG	GET STRUCTURED	SET UP	TAKE FIRST	FILL PRIME	ADD LEVERAGE

STEP 1 — Build dog hours

FREE · TODAY

- Volunteer at a shelter or rescue: handling volume with varied dogs.
- Study learning theory and body language from established trainers' material.

STEP 2 — Get structured training

LOW COST · 1-6 MONTHS

- A recognized certification course gives method and vocabulary.
- No state license is required — results and reviews become the proof.

STEP 3 — Set up the business

WEEKS

- Register, and get liability insurance — non-negotiable with animals.
- Define packages: puppies, manners, reactivity — with clear boundaries.

STEP 4 — Take first clients

MONTHS 2-3

- Start with straightforward cases; refer out what exceeds your skill.
- Film consented before/after content from every program.

STEP 5 — Fill prime time

ONGOING

- Evening and weekend slots are your storefront — staff them first.
- Vets, groomers and rescues are steady referral partners.

STEP 6 — Add leverage

MONTH 6+

- Group classes and online follow-ups multiply your hours.
- Board-and-train, where facilities allow, raises revenue per dog.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- ☐ Today: sign up for shelter volunteering and shortlist certification courses.
- ☐ Days 1–30: handling hours weekly; course started.

□ Days 31–60: business and insurance set; packages written.

□ Days 61–90: first paying clients in beginner-level programs.

□ Day 90: a working solo practice with referrals starting to move.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest "probably NOT you". → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ **TRAIN THE HUMAN TOO.** ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.